



However, some children are very different from their age-mates that they 'stand out'. Such children have to deal with the normal/ usual problems of growth along with all those difficulties that may arise because of being 'different'. The child is unable to deal with the social and emotional problems associated with it. This has marked effect on the child's personal and social development.

Normal Child and Disabled/ Disadvantaged Child

A normal healthy child is able to grow and do things to equip him/her for future life. A child who is not able to withstand the challenges of day-to-day life is generally referred to as handicapped/disabled or disadvantaged children. They are also known as children who are 'differently abled '.

Baker, a well-known psychologist defines the disabled child as "one who deviates from what is supposed to be an average child in physical, mental, emotional and social characteristics to such an extent that the child requires special educational services to help develop to the maximum capacity".

Categories of Disabled/Disadvantaged Children:

The disabled children can be broadly grouped into three categories. These are:

a. Physically disabled children.
b. Mentally disadvantaged children.
c. Socially maladjusted children.

Causes of Disability among Children:

The various causes of physical disability are as follows:

a. Heredity
b. Unfavorable environment
c. Injury during child birth
d. Accidents during early childhood causing orthopedic problems.
e. Surgery requiring the amputation of the diseased part.
f. Mental and emotional problems in early childhood result in stam-mering, stuttering and speech defects.
g. Ear infections and injuries result-ing in hearing defects.
h. Psychological, emotional problems and feelings of neglect result in behavioural problems.

2.2.4.1 Visual Impairment:

Vision is a critical tool that children use in obtaining information about the world in which they live. Impairment of vision can lead to partial or total blindness. The children with visual impairment will need

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